

Rival Colony Border

A local Screeps competition module

[docs/competitions/05-rival-colony-border.md](#)

Summary

The learner expands near a persistent attacker-capable bot and must balance growth, scouting, and defense before the border becomes unsafe.

Skill Target

- Primary: expansion under pressure.
- Secondary: remote-room routing, reservation, threat response, contingency planning.
- Program track: Lead Developer to Architect, Episodes 8, 11, and 12.
- Recommended episodes: [docs/tutorials/08-expansion.md](#), [docs/tutorials/11-scouting.md](#), [docs/tutorials/12-pvp-fundamentals.md](#).

Prerequisites

- Learner can sustain one room.
- Scout code records nearby intel.
- TooAngel is installed and registered as `tooangel`.

Setup

Spawn TooAngel two to four rooms away from the learner:

```
docker exec -it autonate-screeps screeps-launcher cli
```

```
bots.spawn('tooangel', 'W3N1', { cpu: 100, gcl: 1 })
```

Challenge

Choose whether to reserve, claim, or avoid a nearby room based on scout data while the rival colony grows.

Pressure

A persistent bot colony with autonomous behavior. The pressure is strategic: the map is changing while the learner decides.

Win Condition

The learner passes when:

- The scout identifies the rival colony and border rooms.
- The learner records a decision: expand, delay, defend, or avoid.
- The chosen action is implemented in code.
- The home room remains stable while the expansion plan runs.

Scoring

Metric	Full Credit	Partial Credit
Outcome	Expansion decision is executed without collapsing home economy.	Decision exists but requires manual correction.
Code behavior	Scout, expansion, and defense logic share Memory data.	Logic exists in separate one-off scripts.
Debugging process	Learner explains tradeoff with room evidence.	Learner explains from intuition only.

Replay

Move the bot to a different border room or change the time box. Compare decisions across runs.

Reflection

- What signal told you the border was unsafe?
- What did you delay to keep the home room stable?
- When would you switch from expansion to defense?

Extensions

- Easier: make the bot farther away.
- Harder: spawn two rival bots in different directions.
- Team variant: one learner is expansion lead, one is defense lead.